

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Indictment

United States District Court for the Middle District of North Carolina United States v. Mateo Serrano Criminal Action No. SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 Docket Entry 5 Filed November 5, 2025

The fictional grand jury charges Mateo Serrano with one count of conspiracy to commit wire fraud, in violation of 18 U.S.C. §§ 1349 and 1343. From on or about August 4 through November 2, 2025, within the Middle District of North Carolina and elsewhere, Serrano knowingly and voluntarily joined an agreement whose object was to obtain money through materially false reimbursement claims.

The alleged claims concerned services represented as completed for fictional Meridian Community Supply Cooperative when the charged participants knew those services had not been performed. At least one interstate wire communication was used or foreseeably caused in furtherance of the agreement.

Every person, entity, identifier, and event in this indictment is synthetic. The pleading omits transaction mechanics, credentials, account information, communication routes, and evasion methods. It supplies notice of the charge without offering instruction about committing an offense. Serrano is presumed innocent unless and until guilt is established through lawful process.

Count One — Agreement

The grand jury alleges that Serrano agreed with Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, Nessa Holt, and others known and unknown only within this fictional record to pursue the wire-fraud object. The agreement did not require a written instrument. It could be shown by the participants' knowing statements and coordinated conduct during the charged period.

The government would have to prove that Serrano knew the essential unlawful objective and intentionally joined it. Mere association, employment, presence, or contact with another participant would not establish membership. The indictment alleges knowing participation rather than innocent assistance.

Exactly five people are alleged to have been criminally responsible participants: Serrano, Pared, Bell, Venn, and Holt. The numerical statement does not allege that Serrano held a managerial title or supervised another person. Relative role is not an element of Count One and is not resolved by the charging instrument. The government retains the burden to prove guilt beyond a reasonable doubt at trial if Serrano maintains a not-guilty plea.

Count One — Fraudulent Object

The object of the agreement was to obtain reimbursement funds from Meridian Community Supply Cooperative by representing that qualifying services had occurred when they had not. The participants allegedly intended the cooperative to rely on the false statements when deciding whether to release money. The statements were material because the service-completion representation was capable of influencing that decision.

The indictment does not describe how any claim was created, authenticated, submitted, routed, reviewed, or paid. It does not identify a system weakness or concealment practice. Such operational detail is unnecessary to notify Serrano of the charged fraudulent object and is intentionally excluded from this synthetic record.

The grand jury alleges that the agreement produced an aggregate fictional loss of \$186,400. The amount is not a separate element of conspiracy liability and remains subject to evidence, stipulation, and any later sentencing procedure. No real cooperative, customer, account, or financial institution is involved. The pleading concerns only the abstract legal elements of the fictional charge.

Count One — Intent and Materiality

Serrano allegedly understood that the service representations were false and that the cooperative used them in evaluating reimbursement. He allegedly intended the shared objective to succeed and acted to help the group obtain money. The government does not rely on negligence, a clerical error, or disagreement about an ambiguous eligibility rule.

The grand jury alleges materiality from the relationship between completed services and payment eligibility. A claim stating that work occurred could influence a reasonable decision maker when the program reimbursed completed work. This notice does not state that every alleged representation resulted in payment or that Serrano made each communication personally.

Intent and knowledge must be proven through admissible evidence if the case proceeds to trial. The indictment itself is not evidence. Serrano may challenge the allegations, require the government to meet its burden, confront witnesses, present a defense, and remain silent. No inference about guilt or relative role arises merely from the grand jury's return of Count One.

Count One — Interstate Wire Use

At least one member of the alleged conspiracy caused an interstate wire communication while advancing the false-reimbursement objective. The use was allegedly reasonably foreseeable to Serrano as a knowing participant. The indictment need not and does not reproduce the message, technical route, endpoint, provider, authentication, or account data.

The wire nexus is pleaded at a level sufficient to identify the federal object. It does not teach how to use a payment or communication system. The government would be required to support the allegation through lawful evidence, and Serrano may contest whether the communication occurred, crossed state lines, or furthered the agreement.

Liability for the charged conspiracy does not require Serrano to have personally sent every communication, but it does require his knowing and voluntary membership in the agreement with the intended wire-fraud object. The grand jury alleges both. No uncharged event after November 2, 2025, is incorporated as an additional offense act. Later investigation or court proceedings do not extend the charged completion date.

Notice of Consequences and Unresolved Sentencing Matters

Upon conviction, the court may impose only consequences authorized by statute, including imprisonment, supervised release, a special assessment, restitution, and any lawful financial term. The eventual sentence would follow a presentence investigation, notice, an opportunity to object, counsel's advocacy, the defendant's personal allocution, and the court's consideration of the advisory Guidelines and statutory factors.

This indictment does not recommend a sentence or apply an aggravating-role adjustment. Although five participants are alleged, the pleading makes no finding that Serrano managed or supervised Pared or anyone else. Handling information, funds, or activity would not automatically establish management of a person. Any advisory role question is distinct from the elements charged here.

The exact \$186,400 alleged amount gives factual notice but does not establish restitution or a Guidelines calculation by itself. Serrano may contest relevant matters through the prescribed process. The public indictment contains no presentence report, private history, sealed material, or prediction about whether the charge will be resolved by trial or plea.

Grand-Jury Return

The fictional grand jury finds probable cause to return Count One against Mateo Serrano. Its action permits the charge to proceed; it does not determine guilt. The government must still prove every required element beyond a reasonable doubt unless Serrano knowingly and voluntarily enters a guilty plea that the court accepts under Rule 11.

The foreperson confirms that the indictment uses synthetic identities and an abstract factual description. It does not incorporate a real complaint, investigation, victim, program, or financial record. Any similarity to an actual person or event is unintended. Operational details are omitted because they are irrelevant to the training objectives and inappropriate for public dissemination.

Returned in open fictional court on November 5, 2025. The clerk shall assign the indictment to Criminal Action No. SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328, provide a copy to Serrano and appointed counsel, and schedule arraignment or another initial proceeding as directed. All rights and objections are preserved.

Fictional Grand-Jury Foreperson

Bram Ives Fictional Government Counsel